The Line of Departure

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Feature · Military Supernatural Horror · 110 pages

Logline: A Special Forces team escapes a coup into a jungle that won't let them leave, hunted by something that knows their every move, and learns that no one is meant to make it out.

Tagline: *The mission has no end.*

Comps: *Predator* meets *Triangle*.

Synopsis

A starved, filthy Green Beret named COLIN drags himself out of a river, alone, and waits at a stranger's hut as trucks roll toward him. Two weeks earlier, his twelve-man Special Forces team was sharing a last easy night with its partner force.

That night a coup topples the government, and rebels release a video claiming they've executed two Americans. Cut off, with no rescue coming, the team burns its outpost and runs for the border. An ambush at a checkpoint kills two of them. A firefight at a river forces the rest into the current and onto the far bank: thirty klicks of jungle from the border.

The jungle is wrong. Compasses drift. Watches disagree. Noon lasts for hours, then night drops like a switch. Their team's own whistle signal comes back to them out of the dark. One by one the jungle takes them: a snakebite, a mauling, a man pulled down into the mud, two more swallowed by standing water. Something tall and skeletal hunts them through the trees. Bullets don't stop it, and it seems to know their every move.

Murphy, the quiet engineer, kills the Hunter and climbs above the canopy. He sees the truth: every trail curves back on itself, and three versions of his team are marching through the same loop. Then he rolls the body over and finds his own tattoo. The Hunter is Murphy. He stays behind and becomes it.

Nick and Joe reach the river and seem to escape, only to be captured and executed on camera. It is the same video that started everything. Colin, the only one who makes it out linearly, sits in an embassy debrief while an officer explains that Nick and Joe were already buried before the team ever left camp.

Why This Script

- **Authentic from the inside.** The tactics, the radio traffic, the medical choices and the gallows humor come from 22 years in the U.S. Army, the last 13 in Special Forces. This is how a team actually talks, fights and grieves.
- **The team is the protagonist.** It's an ensemble survival story. Every death costs the survivors more control and less understanding.
- **A locked causal loop.** The opening execution video, the Hunter's identity and Colin's impossible debrief all lock together at the end, and the ending makes you want to watch again.
- **Contained and producible.** Most of it plays in jungle exteriors with a small cast, and the horror comes from the environment more than from VFX.

Laurels (2026)

- Script Competition Second Rounder — Austin Film Festival
- Semi-Finalist — 31st Annual Fade In Awards (Sci-Fi)
- Official Selection — Alpine International Film Festival
- Official Selection — The Psychedelic Film and Music Festival

About the Writer

Jason A. Green is a writer-advisor and retired U.S. Army Special Forces Medical Sergeant (18D). He served 22 years in the U.S. Army, the last 13 in Special Forces with C Company, 3rd Battalion, 3rd Special Forces Group (Airborne), with nine combat deployments to Afghanistan, Iraq, Syria, Yemen, Niger and Chad. His decorations include the Bronze Star Medal with Valor and the Purple Heart. His 2026 slate earned 15 competition wins, and he is a two-time Austin Film Festival Second Rounder and an IMDb-credited writer.

WGA Registry #2360351

Contact: jason@calderwarstories.com · (732) 330-3553 · calderwarstories.com · ISA profile